

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, some sun, increasing clouds, light winds, high 67. **Tonight**, mostly cloudy, low 49. **Tomorrow**, cloudy, a late-afternoon shower, light breeze, high 62. Weather map, Page B8.

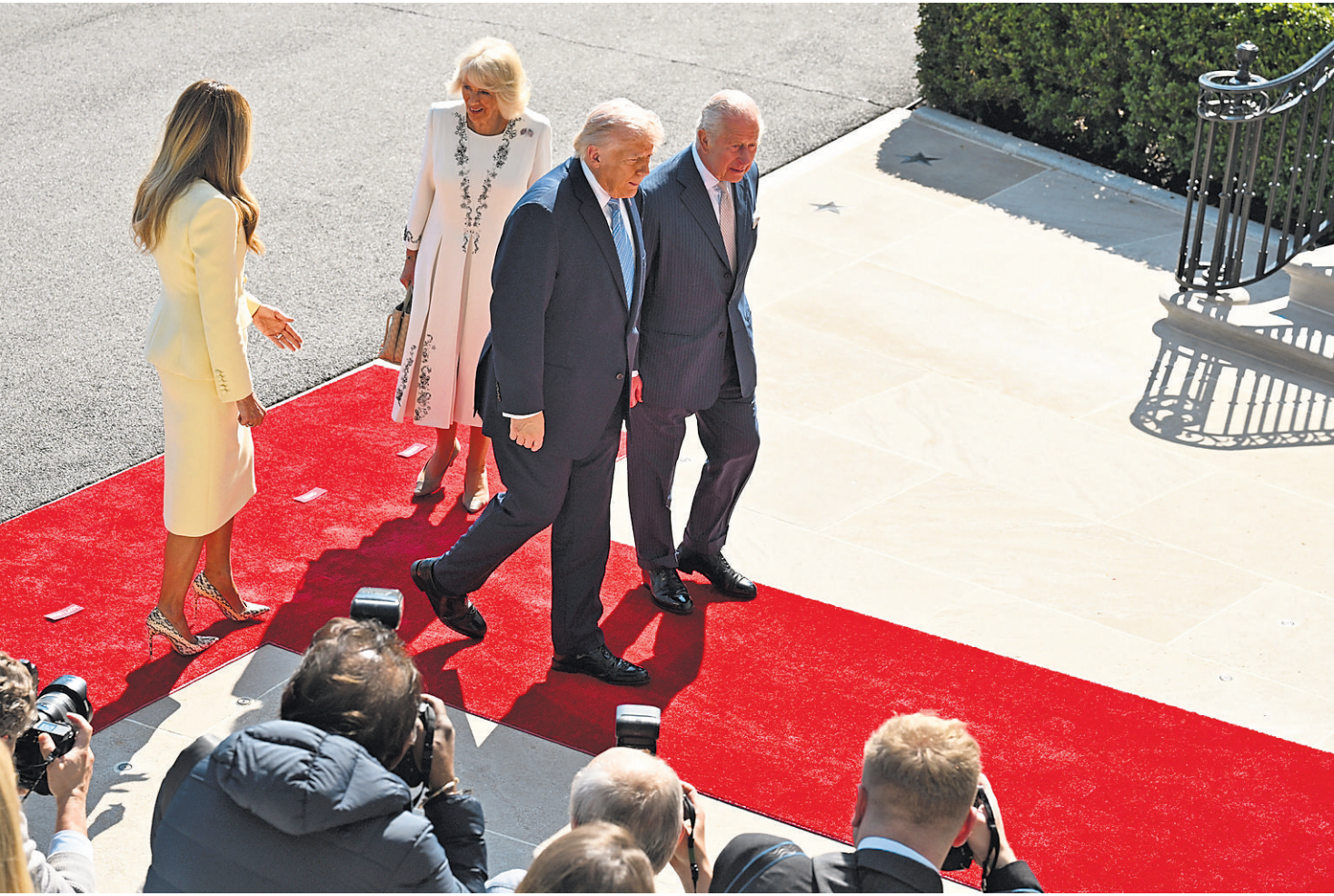
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TUESDAY, APRIL 28, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

A Royal Welcome at the White House
King Charles III and Queen Camilla of Britain met with President Trump and the first lady, Melania Trump, after landing on Monday.

A Google Co-Founder’s Steady Drift to the Right

By THEODORE SCHLEIFER and KATE CONGER

It was a holiday party at a crypto titan’s estate in Marin County, and Sergey Brin had a bone to pick with Gavin Newsom. Mr. Brin, a Google co-founder and one of the world’s richest people, is a longtime friend of Mr. Newsom, the California governor. Both men attended each other’s weddings. But now Mr. Brin pulled Mr. Newsom aside to a different part of the property for a serious talk.

Mr. Brin told Mr. Newsom that he could not stand the state’s pro-

‘MAGA Girlfriend’ by His Side, Brin Joins Many Tech Peers

posed billionaire tax. They were soon joined by Mr. Brin’s girlfriend, Gerelyn Gilbert-Soto, a Trump-loving gut-health influencer. Even as she tried to defuse the tension — joking that she would let Mr. Newsom’s bad policies slide because he was handsome — she argued the measure would wreck California’s economy.

Mr. Newsom, who had never seemed inclined to support the tax, came out the next month and pledged to defeat it. He declined to comment on the interaction.

The December confrontation, which took place at a party thrown by the billionaire Chris Larsen and was recounted by three people briefed on it, reflected Mr. Brin’s new war footing. He is growing more politically agitated, more willing to spend his estimated \$273 billion fortune on elections and evidently more receptive to Republican points of view.

Mr. Brin, 52, long showed little

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Warehouses For ICE Face Legal Delays

By HAMED ALEAZIZ

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration is scrambling to conduct environmental impact reviews of warehouses it plans to convert into immigrant holding facilities, after a flurry of lawsuits claiming the administration sidestepped federal requirements.

The Immigration and Customs Enforcement agency is buying the warehouses to help it increase the rate of deportations, which depends on having enough space to house detainees. The administration currently has about 58,000 immigrants in custody, and fell short of its target to reach 100,000 beds by the end of last year.

But the plan to buy and retrofit commercial warehouses to accommodate tens of thousands more detainees may be delayed after hitting roadblocks, including opposition from residents and officials in the communities where the warehouses are located. Now, states are trying to block the projects by arguing that the

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Within Rikers, Video Games Serve as an Escape

By NICOLE CARPENTER

Talik Thomas spent three days trying to solve a puzzle in the survival horror game Daymare: 1998. In addition to its zombies are the devilishly hard puzzles, one of which requires properly flipping a sequence of switches. It is tricky for a lot of players: Tens of thousands of people have viewed YouTube videos created to help them find the solution.

But inside Rikers Island, the New York jail complex where Mr. Thomas was being held on gun charges, the internet is not freely available. He could not ask Google for help. Instead, he pulled out a notebook to scribble down possible sequences.

“Games like that I do enjoy, because in here, it helps pass the time,” Mr. Thomas, 22, said in an interview at Rikers. “You’re thinking actively, going through different scenarios.”

Video games may seem inconsequential in a place with a reputation for dangerous conditions and inhumane treatment. More than a dozen Rikers inmates died in custody last year, and an independent commission has called the jail complex “a crumbling, inordinately expensive incubator of misery.” (The City Council has ordered the complex’s closure by August 2027, although New York, which plans to replace it with four smaller jails, is unlikely to meet that deadline.)

But for some of the young inmates at Rikers, which houses nearly 7,000 people serving short sentences or awaiting trial, games provide an important sense of normalcy. Mr. Thomas said the pastime — his favorite games are the basketball franchise NBA 2K and the bullet-time shooter Max



PHOTOGRAPHS BY ABDUL KIRCHER FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Rikers Island in New York uses games as a reward to help reduce violence. Inmates say the pastime makes life seem more normal.

Payne — was a good mental release in jail.

“The environment is very hostile at times,” Mr. Thomas said. “It’s a good way to offset the hostility, so I know I’m still me. I don’t always have to be on edge or on my tippy toes about everything.”

Jesus Thompson, who was incarcerated at Rikers for eight months last year on a charge of attempted criminal possession of a weapon, said video games have always been an important coping mechanism.

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Ballroom Builder Got No-Bid Deal for Nearby Job

This article is by David A. Fahrenthold, Luke Broadwater and Andrea Fuller.

WASHINGTON — To build his mammoth White House ballroom, President Trump last summer chose Maryland-based Clark Construction. Since then, Mr. Trump has repeatedly sung the company’s praises, even saying he wanted it to refurbish projects all over Washington.

In January, government documents show, the Trump administration secretly gave the company a no-bid contract to do another job at a sharply inflated price.

The National Park Service wanted to repair two ornamental fountains in Lafayette Park, across Pennsylvania Avenue from the White House. The Biden administration in 2022 had estimated the work would cost \$3.3 million. But Mr. Trump’s government agreed to pay Clark \$11.9 million to do it, and later added tasks that increased the contract to \$17.4 million, the documents show.

The agency did so without con-

Writings Suggest Gunman Nursed List of Grievances

Man Charged in Attack Hid Plan to Target Trump Officials, Authorities Say

This article is by Amy Qin, Chelsia Rose Marcus and Shawn Hubler.

Before he embarked on a cross-country journey, Cole Tomas Allen offered the people in his life a series of explanations for his absence, according to writings that the authorities say he left behind.

He had a personal emergency, he told his colleagues and the students he was tutoring. He told his parents simply that he had an interview. But Mr. Allen appears to have had a much different and much darker plan when he set out on a train from California to Washington.

The Justice Department on Monday formally charged Mr. Allen with attempting to assassinate President Trump two days after investigators said he broke past a security perimeter at the White House Correspondents’ Association dinner in Washington, setting off a flurry of gunfire.

Mr. Allen, who did not enter a plea, came to Washington with a pump-action shotgun, a handgun and three knives with the intent to carry out a political assassination, a federal prosecutor told the judge. Mr. Allen also faces two weapons charges, including discharging a firearm during a crime of violence. [Page A13.]

Those who knew Mr. Allen are struggling to reconcile the man they knew with the shocking act of political violence that he has been accused of perpetrating.

The writings that the authorities attributed to Mr. Allen bounced between remorse for the deception of friends and family and gratitude for a lifetime of love and support. In it, he displayed outrage at the policies put in place by the White House, and alluded to allegations of sexual misconduct, saying that he is “no longer willing” to allow a “traitor to coat my hands with his crimes” — an apparent reference to Mr. Trump, though the writings do not mention him by name.

The two law enforcement officials who shared the writings with The New York Times asked not to be named because they had not been authorized to disclose the information.

Close relatives declined to discuss Mr. Allen’s arrest or did not respond to requests for comment.

The writings said the suspect had come to the Washington Hilton looking for members of the Trump administration.

“Administration officials (not including Mr. Patel): they are targets of violence. [Page A13.]

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A Disquieting Political Routine Of Gunfire and Death Threats

By LISA LERER

The image of raw emotion stood out even amid all the chaos. Erika Kirk, widow of the conservative movement, sobbing in her shimmering white ball gown, as men in suits ushered her out of the White House Correspondents’ Association annual dinner after another moment of violence overtook politics.

It was a symbol of one political trauma fleeing the scene of yet another.

“I just want to go home,” she said, her voice breaking and head bowed.

For Americans across the country, the events of Saturday night were at once shocking and familiar.

Violence has become a routine intruder in the rituals of the nation’s political life, a numbing narrative of assaults, bomb



SALWAN GEORGES FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Representative Steve Scalise, who was shot in 2017, being taken to a secure room.

threats and assassination attempts.

But the location of this incident, in proximity to hundreds of elected officials, aides and lawmakers, underscored another unsettling reality of this violent era: The ever-growing club of

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9
That Perfect Mount Fuji Shot
Unruly crowds of visitors have put a picturesque Japanese town on edge. Residents are pushing back. PAGE A9

Iran’s Outline for Peace
The country proposed opening the Strait of Hormuz to shipping traffic and the U.S. lifting its blockade. PAGE A6

NATIONAL A10-17, 20
The Life Behind a Narrative
President Trump posted footage of an immigrant’s killing by another immigrant to push his agenda, but the actual story was more nuanced. PAGE A10

Exodus of Black Republicans
All four members in the House are retiring, erasing diversity gains in the G.O.P. ranks of Congress. PAGE A14

SPORTS B6-10
A Boundary-Breaking Race
Ideal conditions, teamwork and shoes combined to yield record-smashing times at the London Marathon. PAGE B7



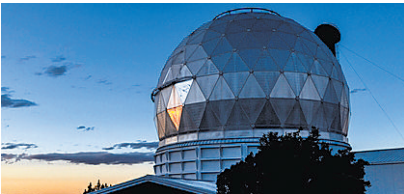
ARTS C1-6
Live, Die and Reprise
A musical adaptation of the 1987 film “The Lost Boys” is an over-the-top spectacle, until its second half. PAGE C1

‘Michael’ Gets Them Moving
Critics have savaged the biopic about the star, but fans were dancing in the aisles on its opening weekend. PAGE C1

BUSINESS B1-5
Children? Can’t Afford Them.
High mortgage payments, higher child care costs and economic uncertainty are making some people rethink their plans on starting a family. PAGE B1

OBITUARIES B11-12
An Artistic Ascetic
Aldwyth made collages and Joseph Cornell-like contraptions that told stories about art history and her place in it. She was 90. PAGE B12

OPINION A18-19
Frank Bruni PAGE A19



SCIENCE TIMES D1-8
Dark Sky and Dark Energy
In a remote part of Texas, the McDonald Observatory offers a portal to the early universe, enabled by the Earth’s largest dark-sky reserve. PAGE D1

